POTPRESS · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

PotPress design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.9	2026-10-25	Amish Chadha	Amish decided D1 (option A), D7, D8 and D9 as recommended on 2026-10-25 ("i concur with your recommendations"); moved to decisions made; D6 stays open (no pick: decide after trials)
0.8	2026-10-24	Amish Chadha	Kit 1.9.1 upgrade: D7 (guard panel corners, a dimension corrected in the model after the D3 interference check), D8 (PR-013, local spares) and D9 (working force and handle effort, from the independent review) added, proposed, awaiting Amish; joint bolt preload made under the standing instruction; value engineering figures carried forward
0.7	2026-10-23	Amish Chadha	D2 to D5 made under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23 (PPR-DDR-006) and moved to decisions made; D6 (remote two-speed pump) proposed; D1 still open; value engineering at USD 1,279
0.6	2026-10-23	Amish Chadha	Kit 1.8 upgrade: concept selection (D1) and the four STEM check fixes

			(D2 to D5) added as open decisions, proposed, awaiting Amish
0.5	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Amish decided the four guard fixes (2026-10-03); moved to decisions made; value engineering at USD 1,169
0.4	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Approved follow-ups carried out: four guard changes found by the ISO 13857 desk check added as open decisions; handle stroke added to the items to confirm; value engineering at USD 1,149
0.3	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Amish approved the recommendations for all five open decisions (2026-10-02); moved to decisions made
0.2	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Budget treated as a value-engineering target
0.1	2026-09-30	Amish Chadha	Register opened; open decisions moved out of the build plan

PotPress design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/`; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list open decisions.

Open decisions

#	Decision	Options	Recommendation	Cost and effect	Source
D6	If pressing trials need more than the working force limit (5.4 t since D9 was decided on 2026-10-25; 6.4 t when D6 was proposed)	(a) A separate two-speed hand pump at waist height on a hose to a single-acting ram, which removes the pump slot from the right guard; (b) a jack with a larger ram for less handle force per tonne; (c) keep 6.4 t and adjust the mix or dwell instead	Decide after trials; (a) if more force is needed	(a) replaces the slot and shield Amish approved on 2026-10-02 and changes the interlock; price to assess	PPR-DDR-006 (D4); PPR-STM-001 S8

D6 is still **Proposed, awaiting Amish**: its recommendation is to decide after pressing trials, so it carried no pick. D1, D7, D8 and D9 were decided by Amish on 2026-10-25 as recommended and are in the table of decisions made. D2 to D5, the four STEM check fixes, were made on 2026-10-23 under Amish's standing instruction and are in the table of decisions made.

To confirm when parts are bought

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	Buy the bottle jack first	Its base, release screw and pump socket set the locating blocks, the interlock coupling and the notch angle	PPR-DDR-004, Q4
2	Mold cavity finish that releases the liner cleanly	Sets the hand finishing of both molds	PPR-DDR-004
3	The pump handle's stroke on the jack bought, and its play in the socket	The slot and shield leave 25 mm beyond each end of the modelled stroke and 5 mm each side; a longer stroke or more play shortens those gaps	PPR-CAL-001, section 15

Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 1,060 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 1,279 (USD 219 over the target). Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The STEM check fixes (PPR-DDR-006, 2026-10-23) added USD 110: larger molds and patterns for the clay shrinkage allowance (items 8, 9 and 15, USD 42), the taller uprights and stem (USD 2) and the lifting set (item 22, USD 66). Hiring the chain block instead of buying it saves most of the USD 66.
- The press alone is USD 1,196 and the QC rack USD 83. The USD 1,060 target was set on 2026-09-27 to cover the whole BOM, QC rack included, so the like-for-like gap is USD 219.

- The fixed inner shield behind the pump slot (decided 2026-10-02) added USD 6. The four guard fixes (decided 2026-10-03, cost accepted by Amish) added USD 20 against the USD 15 estimated: finer mesh USD 8 (items 16 and 20), small-hole plates USD 2, top beam cover plates USD 7 (longer than estimated, to close the upright channel tops too), crank bracket covers USD 4. They are a safety requirement, so savings are sought elsewhere.
- Making the design constructable added USD 92 (PPR-DDR-004): the steel base plate under the female mold, the thicker 450 mm mold flanges, dowels and bushes (items 8 and 9, USD 44), floor anchors, the bolted jack plate and heavier feet (item 1, USD 22), the adapter disc and nut box (item 10, USD 9) and interlock details (item 21, USD 7).
- The fixed guards, front gate and interlock added USD 67 earlier (PPR-DDR-003); they are a safety requirement, so savings are sought elsewhere.
- Savings worth trying: cheaper dowels and bushes, and plywood QC rack shelves cut from offcuts.
- Idea from concept option B (PPR-OPT-001), a suggestion only: a quick approach move before the jack takes the load, to cut pumping time.

Decisions made

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-09-25	TRL 2 review items and recommendations	Amish: "i accept all your recommendations, go with them across all repos."	PPR-DDR-001, PPR-DDR-002
2026-09-27	Guarded version with mesh guards and an interlocked front gate; budget USD 1,060	Amish	PPR-DDR-003
2026-09-30	Design for construction: open-topped male mold, dowel location, M16 joints with spacer tubes, captive lead screw nut, interlock design and other changes that make the press buildable	Amish: "i accept your recommended changes on design that are currently being sent across for my approval"	PPR-DDR-004
2026-10-02	Pump slot: keep the 30 mm slot, approved only with a fixed inner shield or tunnel behind the slot that keeps the platen and molds out of arm's reach, sized in the ISO 13857 check (item 5)	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	PPR-DDR-004, Q2; PPR-DDR-003
2026-10-02	Pump handle: the 158 mm the handle stands outside the guard is operating space, like a door swing, marked on the floor layout; the 1.0 m width limit of R11 applies to the guarded box	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	PPR-DDR-004, Q3
2026-10-02	Demolding: keep the tipping pins for the prototype; the potters at the first partner factory confirm the method, and if they object the pot is lifted out in its liner instead	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	PPR-DDR-004, Q5
2026-10-02	Pressing force: every structural check stays at the full 20 t jack; the working force is a process setting found in pressing trials with a partner factory, starting near 2 t and stepping up	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	PPR-DDR-001, item 9 (as cited in the register); PPR-CAL-001, section 3
2026-10-02	Guard openings: the ISO 13857 desk check is done now rather than at TRL 4, signed by a competent person, and is a hold point before any force above hand pressure	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	PPR-DDR-003; PPR-DDR-004, Q2
2026-10-03	Front and roof mesh: 6.35 mm (1/4 in) welded mesh, 0.9 mm wire, on the front strips, lower front panel, front gate and roof (option (a)); the side and rear guards keep the 12.7 mm mesh	Amish: "PotPress - move forward with the four guard fixes. I accept the cost."	PPR-CAL-001, section 15; BOM items 16 and 20
2026-10-03	Release shaft and pin cable openings: bolted plates behind the front right strip with a 20 mm hole round the 12 mm shaft and a 10 mm grommeted hole round the 6 mm cable (option (a))	Amish: "PotPress - move forward with the four guard fixes. I accept the cost."	PPR-CAL-001, section 15; BOM item 16

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-10-03	Top beam gap: 3 mm steel cover plates bolted to the top flanges (option (a)); as modelled, one plate each side from the crank bracket to the beam end, which also closes the open tops of the upright channels	Amish: "PotPress - move forward with the four guard fixes. I accept the cost."	PPR-CAL-001, section 15; BOM item 16
2026-10-03	Crank bracket: 2 mm sheet covers on its open front and back (option (a)); costed with the guards, BOM item 16	Amish: "PotPress - move forward with the four guard fixes. I accept the cost."	PPR-CAL-001, section 15; BOM item 16
2026-10-23	D2 clay shrinkage: reference filter is the fired size; molds 1.087 times larger for 8 % assumed shrinkage, to be measured on the partner clay; 480 mm flanges; frame 22 mm taller	Made under Amish's standing instruction: "i approve the pilot, and whenever a STEM check fails propose and implement the best fix to the design and constructability."	PPR-DDR-006; PPR-STM-001 M6
2026-10-23	D3 heavy lifts: chain block, two-leg sling and eye bolts for every part over 25 kg; female lift points in the steel base plate; holes plugged before pressing	Made under the same instruction	PPR-DDR-006; PPR-STM-001 B2; BOM item 22
2026-10-23	D4 handle force: working force limited to 6.4 t (PR-004); the handle extension first chosen was dropped after the independent review	Made under the same instruction	PPR-DDR-006; PPR-STM-001 S8
2026-10-23	D5 scrap alloy: A356 wheel scrap sorted before melting; each melt checked by OES or XRF against EN 601; cast yield taken as 80 MPa	Made under the same instruction	PPR-DDR-006; PPR-STM-001 C3
2026-10-24	Joint bolt preload: the 16 M16 10.9 upright joint bolts are tightened to preload (about 300 N·m, 110 kN), so the joints carry 294 kN by friction and do not slip in their 18 mm holes (STEM row S11; finding 4 of the independent review)	Made under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23 (fix rule); no cost change; Amish can reverse it	PPR-STM-001 v0.3 S11; PPR-BLD-001 v0.8 step 8; PPR-CAL-001 v0.12
2026-10-25	D1 concept: keep option A, the hydraulic bottle-jack press (125 of 160, 10.4 % ahead of B); reopen B if trials show the clay forms fully at under about 0.5 t	Amish: "i concur with your recommendations"	PPR-DDR-005 v0.3; PPR-OPT-001 v0.4; `project.yaml` `concept_chosen: A`
2026-10-25	D7 guard panel corners: option (a), as modelled on 2026-10-24: rear guard 884 mm wide, front left strip 152 mm, right side guard 607 mm long, each corner closed by the neighbouring frame's 3 mm edge leg; 23 of 23 openings meet ISO 13857 Table 4	Amish: "i concur with your recommendations"	`cad/src/model.py` `guard_layout()`; PPR-DWG-110 Rev P5; PPR-CAL-001 section 15
2026-10-25		Amish: "i concur with your recommendations"	PPR-PRS-001 v0.16

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	D8 PR-013 local spares: option (a), the text as drafted; the named spares list is confirmed with the partner factory at TRL 4		
2026-10-25	D9 working force: option (a), working force limit lowered from 6.4 to 5.4 t (handle about 148 N with 85 % pump and seal efficiency) and 10 t stated in PR-003 as a structural check case only; EN 1005-3 assessment in the next calculation session; the two-speed pump (b) stays with D6 if trials need more than 5.4 t	Amish: "i concur with your recommendations"	PPR-PRS-001 v0.16 PR-003, PR-004; PPR-CAL-001 v0.13 sections 3 and 5; PPR-STM-001 v0.4 S5, S8; PPR-RSK-001 v0.3 P2, H10